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NEWM-N450

Research Deliverable: User Research

Interview Script:

“Hello [participant name], thank you for taking the time to chat with me today. I am doing a research project for one of my classes at IU about how people find local events in their town. I just have some questions about your personal experiences and there are no right or wrong answers, I am just here to learn from you.”

“This interview should only take about 10-15 minutes. With your permission, I’d like to take notes and possibly record the conversation for accuracy. The recording would only be used by me for this class project and not shared. Is that okay? Do you have any questions before we get started? ”

Demographics

- How old are you?
- What is your occupation?
- Are you a parent?
- How long have you lived in the town?
- How would you describe your social media use (Which platforms, how frequent?)

Task Analysis

- How do you currently find out about events in town?
- Can you walk me through the last time you tried to look up details for a local festival?
- What triggers you to start looking for events? (A flyer, a friend, seeing a post?)
 - Where do you usually end up finding reliable information?
- Have you ever missed an event or found out about an event too late? What happened?
(How did you feel or do?)
- What is the most frustrating part about trying to find local events in your town?
- Have you ever given up looking for an event? What made you stop looking?
- Have you ever used apps like Meetup or Eventbrite to find local events? Why or why not?

Design Requirements

- If there was one place that aggregated all local events, would you check it?
 - What would make you use it regularly?
- Would you prefer a website, an app, or notifications? (all of the above?)
- What information would you need to be able to see about the event(s) to decide you wanted to go?
- Is there anything that would make you not trust or not use something like this?

Wrap Up

“That is everything I need, thank you so much, this was really helpful! Before I let you go, is there anything else you want to add about finding events in your town that we did not cover?” “Alright then thank you, I really appreciate your time today!”

Interview Results

- *Participant 1:*

A 34-year-old sales representative and parent who has lived in town since 2022. They are active on Instagram (80%) and Threads (20%). They primarily find out about events through Instagram pages during the holiday season but rarely see them. They typically rely on word of mouth from friends for concerts and other events they care about, usually hearing about them about a month in advance. When searching for events, they look up events by city and try to find ones near their town. Participant 1 has missed a hockey game because they forgot to buy tickets after a friend mentioned it too late. Their biggest frustration is filtering through a large volume of irrelevant events to find ones worth attending. They have browsed Eventbrite without an account but dislike downloading apps unless they are useful. They would use a centralized hub if it had strong filtering options, personalized preferences, and a newsletter or notification system similar to Ticketmaster and Stubhub. Key event details they need are time, day, cost, location, and specific event descriptions. They would uninstall immediately if they received unsolicited spam notifications.

- *Participant 2:*

A 32-year-old observability engineer and parent who has lived in town for 6 years. They use Facebook daily, primarily for Marketplace. They find out about events through Facebook or physical signs around town and rely on the Facebook algorithm to surface local events, which they note is unreliable. They looked up a lakefront festival about a week or two before the interview on local parks and recreation Facebook pages. Participant 2 has missed many events because they did not proactively search or the

algorithm did not surface the information. They also showed up to an event that had been rescheduled with no notice. Their biggest frustration is relying exclusively on social media, especially for events outside their immediate town. They have never used Meetup or Eventbrite because they are not helpful for small town areas. They would always reference a single source of truth first and would use it all the time if it was actively maintained and updated. They prefer an app since they always have their phone nearby, especially working remotely. Key event details they need are dates, times, locations, and weather conditions. They would not trust a source with misleading or last-minute inaccurate information.

- *Participant 3:*

A 29-year-old BIM Coordinator who is not a parent and has lived in town for less than a year. They use Instagram, Facebook, Bluesky, and LinkedIn a few times a day mostly for news and entertainment. They find events through social networks and Google searches, triggered primarily by seeing a post. They look for event websites or main social accounts for reliable details. Participant 3 often finds out about events after they have already happened, which they describe as disappointing. Their biggest frustration is that big city events dominate search results, making small town events hard to surface. They do not actively look for events and describe themselves as more passive. They have an Eventbrite account but only use it to organize and manage their own Fresk events, not to browse. As someone who organizes events, they noted that anything that helps reach more people is useful. They would use a centralized hub if it had a simple design, up-to-date information, and ticketing options. They prefer an app and need to see time, location, duration, food availability, and a list of activities to decide on attending.

- *Participant 4:*

A 63-year-old warehouse associate and parent whose children are now adults. They have lived in town for 15 years and use Facebook exclusively, every single day. They find events through Facebook, word of mouth from clubs, work, and stores, and physical signs. They typically google a specific festival by name to find details, but only when they already know what they are looking for. They are triggered to search when bored or looking for something to do, and many events they attend are long-standing family traditions. Participant 4 has missed events and noted that phone calendar reminders help but are hard to stay on top of. They also expressed interest in pet-friendly event filters since they often attend events alone. Their biggest frustration is that some events have no website and Facebook does not always provide enough details like cost, parking, and hours. They have never heard of Meetup or Eventbrite, asking "how do you even find out about a site like this?" They would use a centralized hub on weekends and love the idea of discovering events they did not know existed. They also want their Lions Club events to be listed since small clubs cannot always afford advertising. They prefer a website with in-app bell notifications rather than emails. Key details they need are date, time, admission cost, parking cost, and a link for directions. They are concerned about security, want clean design, and would prefer free access supported by relevant ads over a paid subscription.

- *Participant 5:*

A 40-year-old stay-at-home mom and parent who has lived in town for only one year. They use Facebook and Instagram frequently, noting they used social media far less when working full time. They find events through the town Facebook page, Google

searches, and flyers or friends' posts. They described searching for a local festival within the past week and finding it easy through Facebook. As a newcomer to town, they missed many events in their first months because they had no quick way to find out what was going on, having to wait and remember for the following year. They are now more plugged in through clubs like Boy Scouts and school activities. Their biggest frustration is minimal — they feel searching for events is generally easy now that they are more connected. They have never heard of Meetup or Eventbrite and stay primarily in local mom groups on Facebook. They would use a centralized hub and called it "a neat tool for our community." They prefer a website over an app because they tend to silence app notifications and miss things. Key event details they need are time, date, cost, and location, with a strong interest in free and family-friendly events. Their main concern would be unnecessary personal data collection.

Persona



Sara L.

Age: 38 • Parent • Remote

♀ Hobart, Indiana

QUOTE

*"I know there's stuff going
– I just never find out until
it's already over."*

👤 Personal Details

Demographic: Married, 2 kids,
mid 30s

Occupation: Parent,
Remote worker

Devices: Phone, laptop

Social Media: Facebook daily,
Some Instagram

💻 Tech Exposure

1 low 2 Medium 3 High

Comfort

Moderate, uses
apps when useful

App Use

Facebook
Google

📄 About

Sara is a parent of two living in a small Indiana town who wants to stay connected to her community without spending hours searching across platforms. She relies on Facebook and word of mouth to find local events but regularly misses things because the algorithm doesn't surface them. As a newcomer to town, she struggled to find her footing until clubs like Boy Scouts plugged her in. She would use a centralized event hub regularly if it was simple, accurate, and free.

🌀 Patterns & Behaviors

- Scrolls Facebook in morning
- Hears about events through word of mouth & flyers
- Googles events by name only when she already knows about them
- Relies on clubs & school for discovery
- Checks for events on weekends to plan week ahead
- Has never used Meetup or Eventbrite

🎯 Goals

- Find free or affordable family events
- Discover things to do without lengthy research
- One trusted place to check instead of many platforms
- Opt-in notifications – no spam or unsolicited emails
- Event details upfront: cost, time, parking, rain policy
- Wants privacy – no unnecessary data collection

Appendix A: Raw Interview Notes